

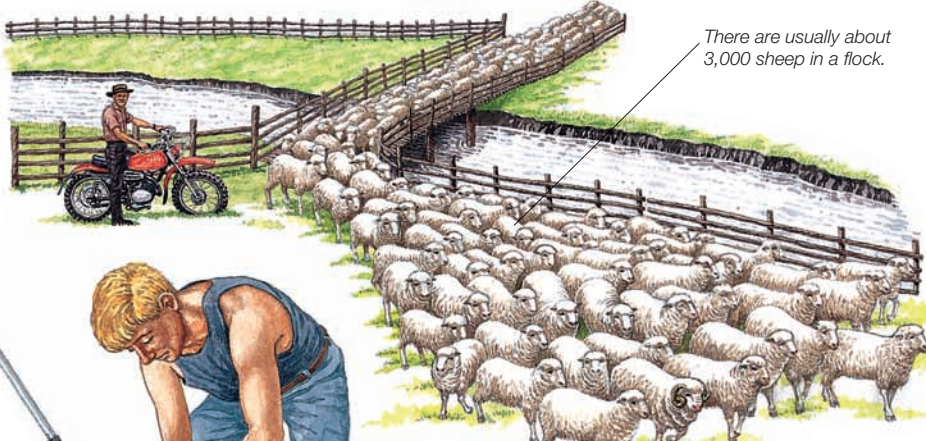
## SHEEP FARMING

Australia is the world's chief wool-producing country, with New South Wales the leading area. Most of Australia's sheep are Merinos, which were brought from South Africa and England in the 1790s. Today, there are about 100 million sheep in Australia most of them on farms called stations. Some stations are huge and cover up to 5,792 sq miles (15,000 sq km), which is half the size of Belgium. Motorcycles and four-wheel-drive vehicles are used to control the livestock over such wide areas.

Sheep usually graze on grass, but eat hay or grain in the summer when pastures are dry.



Drovers ride horses to follow the flock.



There are usually about 3,000 sheep in a flock.



Shearers usually wear blue vests. Some women work as shearers, but most shearers are men.

Some workers can shear more than 100 sheep in a day.



Merino sheep have fine, soft wool.

Farmers keep kelpie and border collie dogs to round up the sheep.

Merino sheep can survive the heat and still produce a heavy fleece of good wool.

Wool is graded and stored in bins.



In Australian Rules football, players can kick or punch the ball, but they must not throw it.

## THE NEW AUSTRALIANS

For many years, Australia allowed only white people to settle; mostly people from Britain, Italy, and Greece. In 1972, this policy was changed, and since then immigrants have arrived from all over the world. The "New Australians" include Vietnamese, Japanese, and Chinese. These groups have brought their own languages, festivals, and types of food.

Many Italians moved to Australia after World War II.



Many Australians have relatives in Britain.

This boy has parents who came from Vietnam.

Many Greek people live in the city of Melbourne.

This girl has parents who came from China.

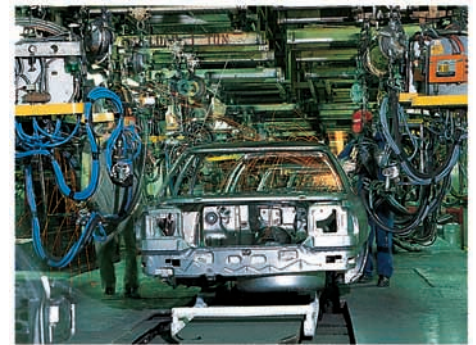
## SPORTING LIFE

Australians love the outdoors, and sports are a major part of their lifestyle. Sandy beaches, warm water, and good surf make swimming, sailing, waterskiing, and surfing extremely popular. Australians are also experts at cricket, tennis, and their own brand of football, called Australian Rules. In the year 2000, Sydney hosted the Olympic Games.



## RICHES FROM THE EARTH

In the 1850s, the discovery of gold in Victoria and New South Wales attracted people to Australia and helped boost the economy. Today, mining for coal, copper, and iron ore, shown above, is still big business. Australia is the world's largest coal exporter and also has the world's most productive diamond mine, near Lake Argyle. However, modern mining relies more on machinery than on labor, and does not employ many people.



## LOOKING EAST

For many years, Australia traded mainly with Britain. However, since Britain joined the European Union in 1973, Australia has strengthened its trading links with the United States and Asian countries such as Japan and China. Today, many foreign companies, including car manufacturers and computer businesses, have set up factories in Australia.

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